

**Education**

Harvard Government Department
Ph.D. Government, *Karl Deutsch Fellow*

Cambridge, MA
May 2028

Harvard Government Department
A.M. Government

Cambridge, MA
May 2025

Princeton University
Emerging Scholars in Politics Program

Princeton, NJ
August 2021

The George Washington University
M.A. Applied Economics, *Dean's Award*

Washington, DC
May 2018

University of Michigan
B.A. Economics & International Studies

Ann Arbor, MI
May 2015

Primary Fields

Comparative politics, political economy, public economics

Secondary Fields

Economic development, cultural economics, narrative economics

References

Melani Cammett (Chair)
Harvard University
mcammett@g.harvard.edu

Nathan Nunn
University of British Columbia
nathan.nunn@ubc.ca

Awa Ambra Seck
Harvard Business School
aseck@hbs.edu

Pia Raffler
Harvard University
praffler@gov.harvard.edu

Mashail Malik
Harvard University
mashailmalik@fas.harvard.edu

Belinda Archibong
Johns Hopkins University
barchib2@jh.edu

Working Papers

Protest Matters: The Effects of Protests on Economic Redistribution (with Belinda Archibong, Evans Osabuohien and Tom Moerenhout). Reject and Resubmit, *Review of Economics and Statistics* [NBER working paper, 2026].

Abstract: Can citizen-led protests lead to meaningful economic redistribution? We study the effects of protests on fiscal redistribution using evidence from Nigeria. We digitized twenty-six years of public finance data from 1988 to 2016 to examine the effects of protests on intergovernmental transfers. We find that protests increase transfers to protesting regions, but only in areas that are politically aligned with disbursing governments. Two natural experiments- the large-scale 2012 Occupy Nigeria protests and 2015 presidential election- validate these results. Protesters also face increased police violence, particularly in non-aligned regions. The results show that protests can influence fiscal redistribution.

The Origins of Women's Economic and Political Participation in Africa. [Draft available upon request].

Abstract: I use differences in women's historical participation in agriculture to explain the heterogeneous incidence of female labor force participation across Africa today. In pre-colonial Africa, task composition primarily determined the gendered division of agricultural labor, giving rise to distinctly men's and women's crops. In the absence of plough machinery across the continent, societies considered soil cultivation and reaping men's agricultural tasks and considered sowing and weeding women's agricultural tasks. I test the theory put forth by Esther Boserup which argues that pre-industrial societies requiring fewer men's agricultural tasks increased the demand for female labor, and in societies where men held less of an advantage over women in crop production, men worked very short hours in agriculture which made it possible to adopt a female farming system. The empirical results suggest that women belonging to ethnic groups with an ancestral female farming system exhibit higher labor force participation and household decision-making autonomy, independent of the original economic rationale. Interestingly, the reduced form results suggest that one implication of the gendered division of crops is that ethnic groups in areas more suitable for indigenous women's crops exhibit fewer gender motifs depicting female domesticity, female submission, and male violence in their historical folklore. To explore political implications, I provide preliminary evidence that these women also engage more in informal politics, suggesting that the appropriate role of non-elite women in the economy continues to be negotiated through persisting political participation.

Works in Progress

What's in a Name? Toponyms, Origin Myths and Women's Economic Empowerment in Africa.

Do "female-named" communities reflect a social history that has led to more economic empowerment for women in some areas today?

Cultural Festivals and the Persistence of Gender Norms Concerning Women's Work: Evidence from an Encouragement Design in Nigeria.

Do cultural festivals, specifically annual harvest festivals celebrating "women's crops," generate the common knowledge necessary for progressive gender norms to be advocated for?

The Effects of Women-Led Protests on Gender Gaps in Political Participation (with Belinda Archibong, Nonso Obikili and Oluseye Ajuwon).

Can protests lead to meaningful changes in political participation, particularly among marginalized groups like women?

Fellowships & Grants

Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, <i>Dissertation Writing Fellowship</i>	August 2026
Econometric Society Africa Summer School	July 2026
Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Mid-dissertation Grant	April 2026
Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Pre-dissertation Grant (x2)	April 2026
John C. Hansen & Katherine Vogelheim, Research Grant	January 2026
Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, GSA Grant (x2)	October 2026
Harvard Center for African Studies, Travel Grant	May 2025
Association for Comparative Economic Studies Summer School (<i>fully funded</i>)	July 2025
Harvard Government Department, Women and Politics Research Grant	April 2025
Harvard Jens Aubrey Westengard Scholarship	May 2024
Forbes 30 Under 30 N. America: Education - Founder, Research in Color Foundation	November 2022
Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Summer Language Grant	April 2022
Harvard Graduate School of Arts and Sciences <i>Graduate Prize Fellowship</i>	August 2021
Harvard Department of Government <i>Karl Deutsch Fellowship</i>	August 2021
American Political Science Association <i>Diversity Fellowship</i>	December 2020
Best Overall Performance in the Applied Economics Master's Program, <i>Dean's Award</i>	May 2018

Teaching Experience

Harvard Department of Government
Teaching Fellow for Matt Reichert
Research Practice in Qualitative Methods

Cambridge, MA
Spring 2026

	Harvard Department of Government Honors Thesis Advisor; Advisee awarded <i>Philippe Wamba Prize</i> for the best senior thesis in African Studies at Harvard College	Cambridge, MA Spring 2026
	Harvard Business School Research Assistant for Hakeem Belo-Osagie Business & Entrepreneurship in Africa	Cambridge, MA Fall 2026, 2025
	Harvard Department of Economics Teaching Fellow for Stan Veuger Public Economics: Designing Govt. Policy	Cambridge, MA Fall 2025, 2024
	Harvard Department of Government Teaching Fellow for Prof. Michael Hiscox Evaluating the Impact of Public Policies	Cambridge, MA Spring 2025
Presentations & Conferences	2026 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting; PhD Excellence Initiative Conference, Stanford University 2025 Harvard Center for African Studies Contested Realities Workshop 2024 African History Through the Lens of Economics, London Business School; J-PAL Research Staff Training, Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2022 J-PAL Research Staff Training, Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
Academic Affiliations	Harvard Center for International Development, PhD Affiliate Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Graduate Student Associate Harvard Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Graduate Affiliate LBS Wheeler Institute's African Research Councillors Programme, Collaborator	August 2025 - Present August 2024 - Present October 2022 - Present May 2022 - Present
Academic Service	Reviewer for: <i>The Annual Review of Economics</i> Harvard Concentration Advisor and Non-Resident Tutor Harvard Resident Tutor, Winthrop House <i>Specialties:</i> French language, public service, first-gen low-income, economics and government	August 2024 - Present August 2021 - 2023
	The Research in Color Foundation Founder and President Since 2019, 95 scholars have benefited from financial assistance and eight months of direct mentorship with economists and quantitative social scientists through my 501(c)(3) non-profit the Research in Color Foundation® . Of those 95, <i>34 alumni</i> have started a PhD in economics or an economics-adjacent field. Research in Color has raised over \$160,000 in scholarship funding for mentees.	May 2019 - Present
Selected Experience	White House Council of Economic Advisers (<i>took leave from PhD</i>) Staff Economist Selected Projects: <i>Economic Report of the President, Chapter 5, Council of Economic Advisers 2024</i>	Washington, DC August 2023 – 2024
	The International Finance Corporation Research Assistant Selected Projects: <i>Making It Big: Why Developing Countries Need More Large Firms, IFC 2020; Creating Impact: The Promise of Impact Investing, IFC 2019; Beyond Capital: Monitoring Development Outcomes of Multinational Enterprises, World Bank 2018.</i>	Washington, DC February – October 2018
	The World Bank Consultant Selected Projects: <i>Surviving Firms of the Syrian Arab Republic, World Bank 2018.</i>	Washington, DC June – August 2017
Technical Skills	RStudio, STATA, LaTeX, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, JavaScript, Microsoft Office Suite	
Languages	English (Fluent), French (Upper-intermediate proficiency), Igbo (Passive proficiency)	
Citizenship	United States; Nigeria	

